

Previs & Layout Checklist for Students

The story is key, not the quality!
There is no need to create everything in 3D, if it is a more efficient way, use it.

Preproduction before Previs & Layout:

- ☐ Story & Script
- ☐ Storyboard (Animatic)
- ☐ Scouting

Previs & Layout

Asset Creation *

- ☐ 3D Models
- ☐ Rigs

3D Shot Creation *

- ☐ Build draft Location (from Scouting)
- ☐ Camera Work
- ☐ Basic Animation
- ☐ Technical requirements met

Cinematography*

- ☐ Composition

Editing *

- ☐ Add Relevant Details
- ☐ Sound

Testing & Evaluation

- ☐ Review

Approved

Rework needed...

Hand Over

- ☐ Edited Sequence
- ☐ Shot-List
- ☐ Prop/Asset List
- ☐ Blocked out Shots

... to Production & Post-Production

Will be used & further discussed with Post & Production Teams

Blocking symbols:

- < Camera
- Characters
- Movements

Storyboard

Use what ever feels comfortable and gets the job done!

Possible Ideas:

- Pen & Paper
- Photoshop
- Blender

Example video



Assets Tools & Links

- Auto-Rig
- UE Marketplace
- TurboSquid.com

Animation Tools & Links

- MoCap
- UE Marketplace
- Mixamo.com
- Software (bellow)

Recommended 3D-Software

- Free (for Students)
- Range of free-to-use assets
- Ease of use
- Industry relevance



Recommended Software

- Ease of use
- Industry relevance



Testing:

- Eye-tracing
- Peer Feedback
- Online Community
- Consider Cinematography!

Ask yourself:

Does the edit fit the pace & emotions of the sequence?

Consider

- 180° Rule
 - Rule of Thirds / Golden Ratio
 - Balance & Pattern
 - Power Dynamics
- More on the back...

Ask yourself:

- Who owns the scene?
 - What is the goal of oneshot?
- To many goals - split it up!

Useful Youtube Cannels

- Wandering DP
- In Depth Cine

Useful Resources:

Reddit | Filmmakers
No Film School
Shotdeck.com

Checklist Updates: www.timonholzer.wixsite.com

* More Information & tips on the back!

Extended Information & Guidance

This page is intended to provide further information and guidance but is not necessarily needed for the checklist to function.

Find out even more on
[screenskills.com](https://www.screenskills.com)

Hand over to other Departments:

Shot List

This may include:

- ☐ Scene & Shot Number
- ☐ Script Reference
- ☐ Storyboard Reference
- ☐ Location
- ☐ Shot Type
- ☐ Camera Angles
- ☐ Camera Movement
- ☐ Audio Reference
- ☐ Subjects & Objects
- ☐ Description/Notes

Prop/Asset List

List of Objects that need to be created or gathered for the production.

Blocked Out Scenes

2D Plan of the Set/Shot from above.

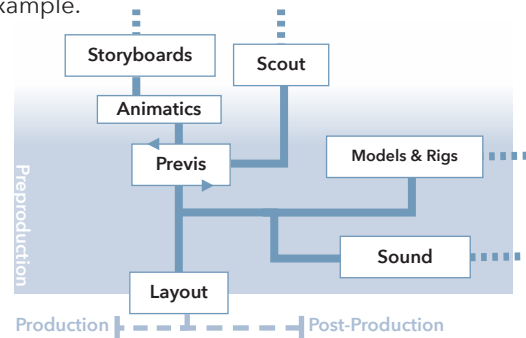
Most Common Symbols:

- < Camera
- Characters
- Movements

Work-flow/ Pipeline Example

There isn't a set Work-flow & Studios defy it differently. The Following is an example.

Previs Pipeline Video



Editing

Relevant Details

- ☐ Scene & Shot Number
- ☐ Frame-Counter
- ☐ Project Title
- ☐ Focal Length (Lens)

Sound

Only if it is relevant to...

- ☐ Story
- ☐ Feeling & Editing (Music, etc.)

Testing & Evaluation

- What is a shot's Purpose?
- Are you trying too much? Simplify!
- Avoid Clichés
- Feedback
- Edit fits emotion & pacing?

3D Shot Creation

Technical Requirements

Productions have limitations of Time, Budget or Technical nature:

- Focal Lengths availability (Talk with DOP)
- Are Shots achievable on a real set?

Rigging & Modelling

Previs might start before assets are created - basic Modelling & Rigging is required.

Create your own or find Assets!

Animation

Keep it rough! Record Reference, consider Mo-Cap

- ☐ Timing
- ☐ Strong Poses

Cinematography:

As Visual Storytelling is key, knowledge of Cinematography is important. Here are some things to consider, rules to follow and break!

Shot Types:

- EWS:** Extreme wide / Establishing
- WS:** Wide Shot
- MS:** Mid Shot
- CS:** Close-up Shot
- ECS:** Extreme close-up

Over-the-Shoulder Shot
French-Over
Two Shot
POV

Reaction shot
Wide-angle shot
High/Low angle shot

Compositon Guides & Rules:

- 180° Rule
- Thirds / Golden Ratio
- Balance & Symmetry/Pattern
- Power Dynamics
- Leading Lines
- Contrast & Affinity
- Light & Negative Space
- Depth of Field
- Lensing
- Staging/Blocking

Ask yourself:

- Who owns the scene?
- What is the goal of the shot?

Camera

The Camera is a reactive observer of the action

- ☐ Use Camera Rigs
- ☐ Consider the budget and space limitations

Camera Movements:

Dolly: Moving the camera
Pan: Pivot (horizontal)
Tilt: Pivot (vertical)
Static: No Movement
Hand-held

Zoom: Lens only

Vertigo/ Dolly Zoom:

Zoom & Dolly in opposite directions